James Vickers MCIM MCIPR

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Senior marketing leader with ten years in CMO, Head of Marketing and senior PR/brand roles across cycling, fitness tech, fintech and Web3. Currently Marketing Consultant at Ribble Cycles and Fractional CMO at AI wealth-advisory platform chatwithmotif.com. Track record in brand repositioning, complex multi-channel campaigns, team leadership, PR and owned-media, paid performance, and embedding AI/ML across marketing, product and finance. Proven ability to scale subscription, D2C and brand-led businesses across the UK, Europe and globally.

KEY SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Marketing Strategy - **Brand Strategy** - **Brand Creative Direction** - Campaign Management - Content Strategy - GTM Strategy - Positioning & Messaging - **PR Strategy** - **Owned Media Strategy** - Media Relations - Press Office - Thought Leadership - **Paid Performance Marketing** - **SEO** - SEM / PPC - CRM & Lifecycle Email - eCommerce - Analytics & Attribution - Sponsorships & Partnerships - Ambassador & Influencer Marketing - Event Management - Pro Team Activation - Agency Management - Senior Marketing Leadership - Team Building - Business Development - Budget Ownership (£1.2M+) - Investor Relations - Funding - Board-Level Reporting - AI & Machine Learning - AI Agent Orchestration - Vibe Coding - Vibe Marketing - Organisational Automation - Claude Code

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

Ribble Cycles - High-Performance D2C Bike Brand **Nov 2024 - Present**

Head of Brand and Marketing (Nov 2024 - Jan 2026), now retained Marketing Advisor three days a week

Budget responsibility: £1.2M. Landed 2024/2025 budget under at £920,000.

- Reshaped the marketing team - reorganised roles and responsibilities across the department.
- Built organisational structure - processes, planning, and a new task management platform.
- Day-to-day management of marketing team, retail stakeholders, and agencies.
- Onboarded Shift Active Media (PR) and Commute Films (creative video production).
- Board-level impact - strategic presentations to the board as part of the SMT to PE Owners.
- Built strategic PR process - managed product-to-journalist pipeline on schedule. Secured BBC and ITV TV coverage in 2025.
- Coverage growth - articles 135 to 196, est. views 1.89M to 4.42M, potential audience 117M to 327M.
- Brand repositioning - shifted perception from "budget heritage" to "high-performance technical" - ULTRA-RACE compared to Colnago rather than Planet X or Dolan.
- Ribble Outliers - thought leadership on LinkedIn alongside B2C content. Partnership marketing with Precision and Restrap added 8,000+ email subscribers.
- Presenting Partner, British Gravel Championships - digital and physical rights negotiation, planning, and execution.
- Gravel category growth - Ribble's fastest-growing segment, +2pp above market, taking competitor share.
- ALLGRIT & ULTRA-GRIT go-to-market - wrote the positioning and messaging framework and the GTM plan for the range and its material variants, ran the press tour, and produced the showroom and retailer education assets with localised versions for each market. Ribble's most successful new product launch.
- Ribble Outliers race programme - all four national titles at the 2026 UK Gravel National Championships, 2nd at the UCI Gralloch with Jenson Young, and a team film from The Traka in Girona.
- The Original Outliers rebrand - led the rebrand with FreshBritain as my first major project and rolled it out across retail, the website and social. Closely involved in the messaging, and carried it through the tone of voice and product copy.
- 2025 strategic objectives - grow gravel market share, increase regional penetration (NE and South), launch four new bikes.
- Led NPD marketing - market gap analysis, sign-off documents, and GTM strategies.
- Smurfit Westrock & Cyclist magazine - "Welcome to Hell" mini-documentary on the CiCLE Classic win.

motif - AI-Powered Wealth Advisory (Fintech) Jan 2025 - Present

Fractional CMO (ESOP Holder)

Originally an advisory board role. ESOP holder handling the full marketing mandate with a small team and budget. motif is being built using Claude Code - actively involved in product feature development.

- Full marketing ownership: brand and website development, hosting, updates, and social media management.
- Pivoted to B2B outreach, contacting 1,000+ fintech organisations to develop the sales pipeline.
- Generated a qualified "under-negotiation" phase of over £150M in assets under management across seven entities.
- Built a pipeline of approximately 30 prospects in varying stages.
- AI product development - actively involved in building features within the motif app using Claude Code.

Manual Focus - Marketing Consultancy for Endurance Sport and Cycling Brands 2009 - Present

Founder

- Light Meter - built and launched an AI visibility audit that measures which brands six AI engines recommend. Its first study put 309 buyer questions to the engines for 5,562 answers and was covered by BikeBiz.
- Rider Panel - launch simulation in a market of AI agents, launching November 2026.
- Clients include Ribble Cycles and Pyramid Plastics. Founded in 2009 as a marketing agency for electronic music artists and labels, and the vehicle for my consultancy work since 2026.

Classified Cycling - Cycling Component Manufacturer May 2024 - Oct 2024

Head of Marketing and Communications

- Led the research, validation, and integration of brand and product positions.
- 160+ media placements - spearheaded global product launches, including the Vistar // Powershift drivetrain at Eurobike.
- Global events - managed Eurobike, Sea Otter, and Taichung Bike Week to strengthen partnerships and drive growth.
- AI/ML adoption - led adoption of AI and machine learning across departments.
- Team leadership - led the marketing team and agencies to deliver cohesive digital, PR, and social campaigns.
- Enhanced education and process for IBDs and distributors.

Muuvr - Move-to-Earn Application Jan 2023 - Jun 2024

Chief Marketing and Communications Officer

- Brand development - led Muuvr's brand and visual identity from scratch, including persona work.
- AI strategy - designed and implemented AI strategies across product, marketing, and financial decision-making.
- $4.5M fundraise - contributed to a successful fundraising effort securing $4.5M in investment.
- GTM execution - oversaw go-to-market strategy, procured and managed agencies across creative, performance, and PR.
- Gamification - led development of key gamification strategies driving user engagement.

Wahoo Fitness - Multi-faceted Indoor Training Platform Apr 2022 - Dec 2022

Head of Marketing (Subscription Services)

- Led strategic development and execution of Wahoo X's integrated marketing strategy.
- Directed go-to-market, PR, partnerships, product innovation, and multi-channel marketing.
- Managed global product launches and expanded RGT retail presence to 500+ retailers.
- Led the Wahoo X GTM Fall 2022 campaign, securing media coverage in 20 top publications.

RGT Cycling - Indoor Cycling Platform Jul 2019 - Apr 2022

Chief Marketing Officer (2021-2022) - Head of Brand & Marketing (2019-2021)

- Co-founded RGT Cycling. Drove register-to-ride conversions from 20% to 45% within 12 months.
- Grew subscribers from 0 to 10K and registered users from 100 to 450K. MOU/WAU increased ~3,000%.

- Directed content strategy generating over 2.2M sessions from ~1M users.
- Improved prompted brand recall from 2 to 95 and unprompted from 0 to 75.
- Defined GTM flywheel utilising partnerships with over 100 brands. Elevated NPS from -65 to +45.
- Played critical role in corporate strategy and due diligence during acquisition by Wahoo Fitness.

Wattbike - Indoor Training Bike **Apr 2018 - Aug 2019**

Marketing & PR Manager

- Media perception shift - shifted perceptions of the Wattbike Atom, improving mid-funnel retention and driving conversions.
- Global events - delivered growth through events across the UK, Europe, and Africa.
- Ambassador marketing - built the framework for selecting and engaging ambassadors and high-profile talent.
- International support - provided tailored marketing materials and training for distributors and dealers.

Pelotan - Cycling Specific Sun Protection **Feb 2018 - Dec 2020**

Consultant Marketing Director

Ribble - High-End D2C Bike Brand **2017 - 2018**

Head of Brand & Marketing

Developed and executed brand and marketing strategies. Led digital efforts (SEO, performance, email). Directed content creation and oversaw influencer partnerships.

Planet X Bikes - D2C Bike Brand **2015 - 2017**

Head of Sales and Marketing

Developed and executed sales and marketing strategies driving revenue growth. Led digital marketing, optimised eCommerce, and implemented customer segmentation. Built key supplier relationships.

ADDITIONAL

Professional Accreditations: MCIM - MCIPR

Personal Interests: Road Cycling - Gravel - 5th in age group, UCI Gravel Cymru 2026 - 9th (40-44), UK Gravel National Championships 2026 - XC MTB - Travel - Adventure Sports - Sustainability - Technology - AI

AI Exploration / Side Projects: Aster (2025, Founder) - real-time event tracking platform shipped to iOS and Android, built and operated solo with orchestrated AI agents. Wattplan (2025, Founder) - AI-powered endurance training app built end-to-end with Claude Code (wattplan.cc).

Industry Network: Extensive network in cycling built over almost 15 years. Deep relationships with journalists, brands, athletes, agencies, retailers, distributors, and event organisers across the UK and Europe.

Travel: 30% possible - UK, Europe.

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

MCIM - Marketing - MCIPR - Public Relations

Higher Diploma - Fishing & Fishery Sciences & Management (Distinction)

ISEB - BCS Requirements Engineering - ISEB - BCS Certificate in Business Analysis

Information Technology Infrastructure Library (ITIL)